



House of Representatives

General Assembly

File No. 545

February Session, 2026

House Bill No. 5528

House of Representatives, April 9, 2026

The Committee on Government Administration and Elections reported through REP. BLUMENTHAL of the 147th Dist., Chairperson of the Committee on the part of the House, that the bill ought to pass.

AN ACT REQUIRING PUBLIC AGENCY EMPLOYEES TO ATTEND FREEDOM OF INFORMATION ACT TRAINING.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. Subsection (e) of section 1-205 of the general statutes is
2 repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October*
3 *1, 2026*):

4 (e) (1) The Freedom of Information Commission shall conduct
5 training sessions, at least annually, for members of public agencies for
6 the purpose of educating such members as to the requirements of this
7 section and sections [1-7 to 1-14, inclusive, 1-16 to 1-18, inclusive,] 1-200
8 to 1-202, inclusive, [1-205] 1-205a, 1-206, 1-210 to [1-217] 1-219, inclusive,
9 1-225 to 1-232, inclusive, and 1-240 [, 1-241 and 19a-342] to 1-242,
10 inclusive.

11 (2) On and after October 1, 2026, each member of a public agency shall
12 complete such training. Each member employed on October 1, 2026,

13 shall complete such training not later than March 1, 2027, and any
14 member hired after October 1, 2026, shall complete such training not less
15 than six months after commencing employment. The commission may
16 create a videorecording or digital recording for purposes of offering
17 such training.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:

Section 1	October 1, 2026	1-205(e)
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GAE *Joint Favorable*

The following Fiscal Impact Statement and Bill Analysis are prepared for the benefit of the members of the General Assembly, solely for purposes of information, summarization and explanation and do not represent the intent of the General Assembly or either chamber thereof for any purpose. In general, fiscal impacts are based upon a variety of informational sources, including the analyst's professional knowledge. Whenever applicable, agency data is consulted as part of the analysis, however final products do not necessarily reflect an assessment from any specific department.

OFA Fiscal Note

State Impact:

Agency Affected	Fund-Effect	FY 27 \$	FY 28 \$
Various State Agencies	GF - Potential Cost	See Below	See Below

Note: GF=General Fund

Municipal Impact:

Municipalities	Effect	FY 27 \$	FY 28 \$
Various Municipalities	Potential Cost	See Below	See Below

Explanation

The bill requires that all state and applicable municipal employees complete Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) training offered by the Freedom of Information Commission (FOIC), resulting in a potential cost to various state agencies and municipalities beginning in FY 27.

There is a potential cost to the extent that state and applicable municipal employees will need coverage while completing the FOIC Training. The exact cost will depend on the number of essential employees requiring coverage, the duration of the training, and the pay rates for those covering them. Costs will be reduced in FY 28 as only new employees will need to undergo training; current employees must complete training in FY 27.

The bill additionally requires that FOIC update training standards, which has no impact, as FOIC has sufficient expertise to adjust its training material.

The Out Years

The annualized ongoing fiscal impact identified above would continue into the future subject to wage inflation.

OLR Bill Analysis**HB 5528*****AN ACT REQUIRING PUBLIC AGENCY EMPLOYEES TO ATTEND
FREEDOM OF INFORMATION ACT TRAINING.*****SUMMARY**

This bill requires that each member of a public agency take educational training sessions that the Freedom of Information Commission (FOIC) currently offers to members on Freedom of Information Act- (FOIA) related topics. The bill requires a member employed on October 1, 2026, to complete the training by March 1, 2027, and any member hired after October 1, 2026, to do so within six months of starting employment. The bill permits FOIC to offer the training by video or digital recording.

Current law requires FOIC to hold annual training sessions for members of public agencies on FOIA's provisions (such as public record and meeting-related requirements). The bill eliminates requirements for FOIC to hold training on (1) physical requirements for public records (such as standard ink) and (2) the general prohibition on smoking indoors. It adds requirements for the commission to hold trainings on (1) contracts for the performance of a governmental function, (2) veterans' military records, (3) court actions involving FOIA, and (4) the commission's recommended budget appropriations and allotments.

By law, a "public agency" generally includes state executive and legislative agencies and other state entities, municipalities and political subdivisions and their agencies and other entities, judicial offices' administrative functions, an entity that is the functional equivalent of one of these, and certain nonprofit development corporations designated by a municipality related to certain projects.

EFFECTIVE DATE: October 1, 2026

BACKGROUND***Related Bill***

HB 5250 (File 316), favorably reported by the Government Oversight Committee, makes similar changes to the content of trainings given by FOIC to conform to current practice.

COMMITTEE ACTION

Government Administration and Elections Committee

Joint Favorable

Yea 19 Nay 0 (03/23/2026)